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Photo on the cover courtesy of Carey Carmichael Case of Wild Iris Photography

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Velkommen to "Alaska's Little Norway"

The town that fish built

Welcome to Petersburg, known for its mix of Norwegian and Tlingit heritage and for harboring one of Alaska's most prosperous fishing fleets.

Fishing has been an Indigenous tradition on Mitkof island since time immemorial. Archeological evidence of large scale fish traps have been identified on many of the major waterways on the island. The oldest of which has been dated to thousands of years old, and the Sandy Beach area long served as a productive fish camp for the local Tlingit community.

Around the turn of the 20th century, a Norwegian, Peter Buschmann, eyed the blue ice of LeConte Glacier. Buschmann decided the north end of Mitkof Island, with the idea of ice available nearby, would be an ideal spot for a cannery.

In 1897, construction began on the new site for Icy Straits Packing Co., for which Buschmann was manager. Icy Straits also built a sawmill to cut lumber for the building of the cannery, which was completed in 1900. Docks, homes, warehouses and other businesses sprang up around the cannery and in 1910 the city of Petersburg was incorporated.

Many of Petersburg's residents can trace their heritage back to Norwegian ancestors, who followed Peter Buschmann to the snowy mountains and fjords that reminded them of home. At one time, Norwegian was commonly heard on the town's wooden streets and Norwegian Constitution Day is still celebrated during the Little Norway Festival each May.

Fishing continues to be the backbone of the economy, with around $30 million in seafood landed and processed. Tourism has replaced logging as another driver of the local economy, though harvest of second-growth timber in the region is an emerging industry.

Welcome to our busy, working fishing community that enjoys hosting summer visitors.

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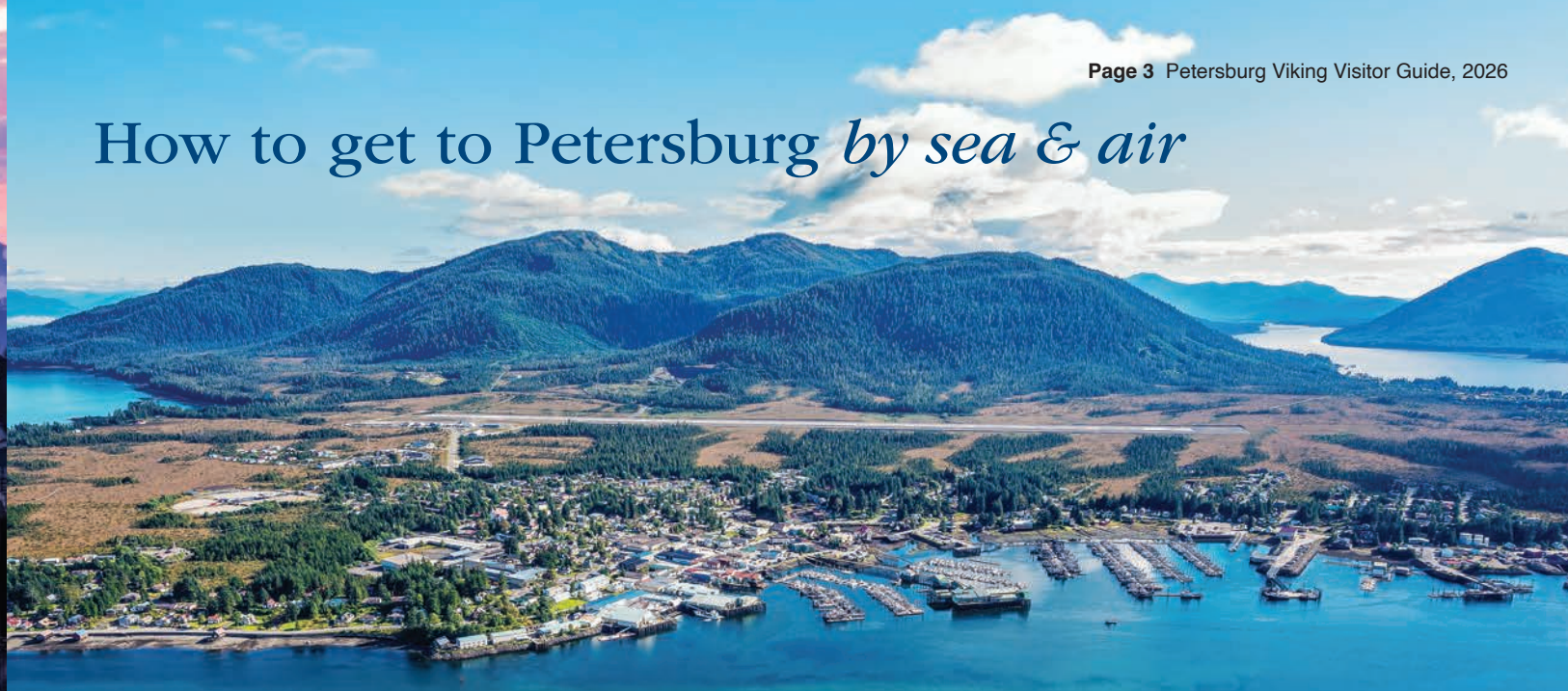

Getting to Petersburg is part of the adventure. To reach Mitkof Island, where Petersburg is located, you will have to fly or float. Independent travelers arrive on Alaska Marine Highway ferries.

Small cruise ships also bring guests to our shores.

Alaska Airlines provides twice-daily jet service from Seattle or Anchorage. Chartering a smaller air or water taxi works, too! And best of all, Petersburg is off the beaten path of the large cruise ships, keeping it less crowded than many tourist destinations.

Petersburg hosts a growing flotilla of luxury yachts, owned and leased by the rich and famous. It is a popular port of call for smaller cruisers from both Alaska and along the western coastline of the lower 48.

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Petersburg by season

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SPRING			SUMMER			FALL			WINTER		
MARCH	APRIL	MAY	JUNE	JULY	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	OCTOBER	NOVEMBER	DECEMBER	JANUARY	FEBRUARY
35.2° F	41.2° F	49.0° F	54.3° F	56.9° F	56.5° F	51.4° F	43.7° F	36.4° F	31.5° F	32.5° F	32.0° F
12H daylight	14H daylight	17H daylight	18H daylight	17H daylight	15H daylight	13H daylight	10H daylight	8H daylight	7H daylight	7H daylight	9H daylight
7.7"	6.8"	6.0"	5.0"	5.9"	8.7"	13.8"	14.0"	11.6"	11.2"	11.9"	6.7"

Petersburg has average recorded temperatures of 54.3 degrees in June, 56.9 degrees in July and 56.5 degrees in August, according to National Weather Service data.

Petersburg's typical weather patterns bring a lot of rain. The average annual rainfall for the area is close to 110 inches. Compare that to an annual average of just 16 inches in Anchorage, 11 inches in Fairbanks, or even 38 inches in Seattle and the weather in Petersburg may look inhospitable.

But the same ocean conditions that bring in all the moisture also moderate the temperatures. This makes for mild winters and cool summers. Even in the coldest month, January, temperatures often stay above freezing.

People who live in this climate adapt. The essential piece of rain gear, either on sea or land, is a good pair of rubber boots, sometimes called "Petersburg sneakers." Style takes a back seat to the comfort of dry feet, and it is not out of place to wear these brownish-red boots on almost any occasion.

On the other hand, umbrellas are uncommon, as serious outdoor work or play is more comfortable in raingear.

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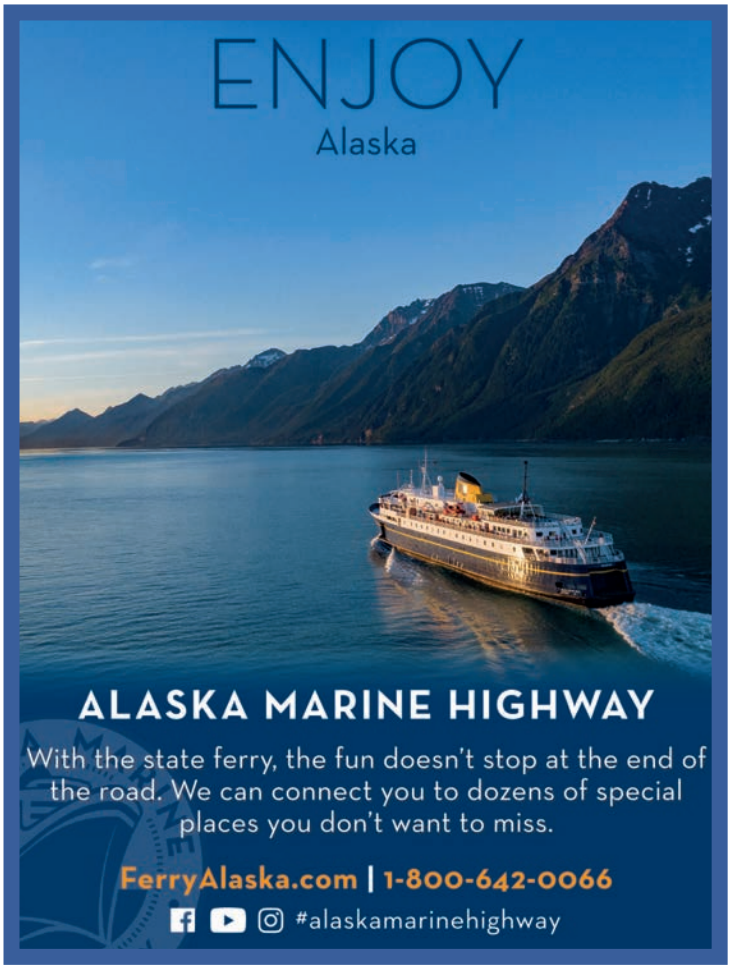

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Petersburg Borough

Petersburg facts and statistics at a glance

• **POPULATION: 3,436 within the Petersburg Borough in 2024.**

• **SIZE: Mitkof Island is 23 miles at its longest point and about 16.5 miles wide at its widest point, covering 211 square miles. Much of the island's flat land is covered by muskeg bogs.**

• **GEOGRAPHY: The island's highest point is Crystal Mountain, which reaches an elevation of 3,317 feet. Mitkof Island is separated from Kupreanof Island by the 20-mile-long Wrangell Narrows, which, in some areas, is just wide enough to accommodate the state ferries. The tide in the narrows can vary as much as 23 feet in one day from high tide to low tide.**

• **ANNUAL PRECIPITATION: The average annual precipitation is around 110 inches. About half of that falls in September, October, November and December, though summers can be very rainy. 2025 was especially rain-drenched with 134 inches of rainfall on Petersburg, including 18 inches rain that fell in May.**

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• **DAYLIGHT: 17 hours and 50 minutes on the summer solstice; six hours and 46 minutes on the winter solstice.**

• **PERSONAL INCOME: The estimated median household income for the Petersburg Borough census area is $75,125.**

• **DEMOGRAPHICS: The median age in Petersburg is 45.7 years old. Petersburg is roughly 62% white, 9% multiracial, 6% American Indian & Alaska Native, 12% Asian, around 9% Hispanic or Latino, and 2% Black.**

• **ECONOMY: Fishing is the economic force that drove the creation of Petersburg and continues to be a driving force in today's economy. According to NOAA Fisheries, in 2024 Petersburg generated $29.8 million in fish landings, and ranked 20th place by volume in the nation.**
The town's seafood processors employ a total of about 1,100 people during a busy summer season.

• **EDUCATION: About 90.6 percent of the population over 27.5 has at least a high school education. About one quarter have a bachelor's degree or higher.**
The Petersburg public school system has around 400 students enrolled in grades K-12 and in 2020 reported a 100 percent high school graduation rate.

• **HOUSING: The median value of owner-occupied housing units is $315,100. The median mortgage cost is $1,568, and the median gross rent is $950, according to US Census 2024 estimates.**

• **ELECTRICAL: Borough owned Petersburg Municipal Power & Light provides electrical power to the borough. The majority of Petersburg's power comes from the Tyee Hydro facility in Bradfield Canal connected by an 83-mile transmission line. The local hydroelectric power source is located at Crystal Lake on Crystal Mountain south of Petersburg and generates around 25% of the Borough's power. Stand-by diesel generated sources provide back-up power to the borough.**

• **GARBAGE: Municipal solid waste is collected by the borough's sanitation department, baled, and shipped to the Roosevelt Regional Landfill in Washington State. Wood products and metals are processed within the Petersburg landfill and curbside recycling pickup is provided by the borough.**

• **UTILITIES: Petersburg's Water Utility treats, filters, and disinfects surface water from its two reservoirs, Cabin Creek Dam and City Creek Dam, which have a combined capacity of approximately 267 million gallons. A few homes use cisterns, wells or have water delivered. Municipal sewage receives primary treatment.**

• **TOTAL TAXABLE PROPERTY VALUE: About $445 million Borough-wide.**

• **GOVERNMENT: Petersburg Borough has a manager/assembly form of government. The borough's annual general fund budget is $13.5 million.**

Photo courtesy of Jeremy Collison

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See ad on page 19

- **COMPASS COOKERY:** *26 Sing Lee Alley, P: 907-650-7707*

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Community events throughout the year

Little Norway Festival — The third full weekend in May, Petersburg's celebration of Syttende Mai — May 17, Norwegian Constitution Day — is Petersburg's biggest festival featuring food and crafts downtown, parade, pageant, melodrama, dances and much more.

Photo courtesy of Jeremy Collison

Devil's Thumb Chamber Music Festival – May 20 -23, this new chamber music festival brings world class artists to perform classical music in Petersburg.

The Market in Petersburg – Every other Saturday throughout the summer handmade and homegrown arts, crafts, produce, and baked goods are sold by local vendors.

Fourth of July — Petersburg's old-time Independence Day celebration with food concessions and craft booths, a parade, carnival games, street games, races and contests, logging events and a fireworks display at night.

The Petersburg Arts Council hosts concerts — throughout the year, featuring local artists and bringing touring performers to Petersburg.

Rainforest Festival — The festival takes place the second week of September and features science, art, and education events including lectures and field trips, walking tours, workshops, visiting artists and authors, and collaborative community art installations. Their website is akrainforestfest.org.

Oktoberfest Artshare — In October, the largest arts and crafts fair in Petersburg sponsored by Muskeg Maleriers, features handmade items by artists and crafters from Petersburg as well as around the state, quilt show and auction, food booths and entertainment.

Parade of Light and Christmas Tree Lighting Ceremony — Friday after Thanksgiving, the community parades by candlelight to the Christmas tree, a local honoree lights the tree and music is performed, kicking off the Christmas season.

Julebukking — Christmas Eve. The streets of downtown Petersburg fill with shoppers as, according to Norwegian tradition, merchants offer customers food and spirits in appreciation for their business that year.

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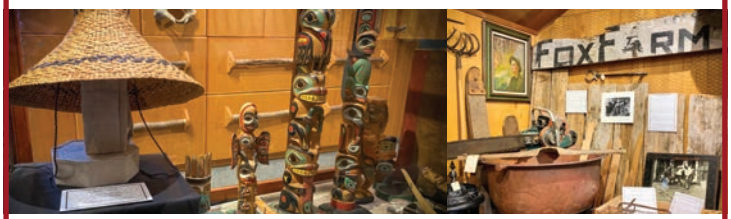

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How to make the most of your time in Petersburg?

Petersburg is a small town with a metropolis sized list of things to do. For more information drop into the Petersburg Visitor Information Center at 1st & Fram St. or call (907) 772-4636.

It is advisable to make reservations for specific tours before you arrive in town.

Tours are sometimes fully booked on specific days, especially in July and August.

Just one day?

OUTDOORS

Schedule a wilderness adventure in the morning with one of our local charters or tour guides to take you out by land, sea, or air. Take a trip to LeConte Glacier or break out the rods for a half-day fishing trip.

Go above the clouds in a float plane or helicopter to get a bird's-eye view of our beautiful mountains, glaciers, and wildlife.

SHOPPING AND DINING

Shopping in Little Norway: If we ain't got it, you don't need it. But come see what we do have. Petersburg's locally owned shops and galleries feature the work of our many local artists and craftspeople.

Stay even longer!

Enjoy Petersburg's fresh island air by walking, biking, or scootering to a trail or one of our easy to access beaches. Check out "Walks & hikes close to town" on Pages 16-17, "Hungry Point Trails system" on Page 18 and Sandy Beach Park on page 26.

Explore Mitkof Island's scenery and wildlife by hopping on an organized van tour or rent a car to chart your own path. See detailed map on page 24 and check out Walks and Hikes "Out the Road' on page 28-33.

Go whale watching in Frederick Sound and find humpback or killer whales feeding and thriving in our rich waters.

Visit our neighbors on Kupreanof Island or in Wrangell.

Go to Kupreanof and take a remote hike or rent a kayak and paddle up Petersburg Creek.
See "Hikes on Kupreanof Island" on Page 34-35.

Go to Wrangell and see the beauty of the Stikine River-the longest free-flowing navigable river in North America.

Photo courtesy of Jeremy Collison

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Photo courtesy of Alisa Jestel

Norwegian dishes and fresh fish

Nearly without exception, visitors seek out Norwegian pastries and fresh seafood when visiting Petersburg.

Seafood is readily available from local vendors who are willing to ship frozen products home for you. Don't expect bargain prices. Seafood is a commodity sold worldwide, so expect to pay market rates.

Local charter yachts, visiting cruise ships, and overnight excursion vessels often purchase fresh seafood items when in port and serve it onboard to their guests.

The freshest seafood is that which you catch yourself. Fishing charters will provide that opportunity.

Norwegian baked goods may be available at catered events but are rarely offered at restaurants, except on special occasions. During the Christmas holidays, Petersburg is famous for its Julebukking. Merchants set out trays of homemade delicacies for their customers to enjoy along with a variety of beverages. The Little Norway Festival offers the best opportunity for some Norske fare. The Sons of Norway features a sampling of authentic pastries, cookies and open-faced sandwiches at their Kaffe Hus each May. The Sons also host potlucks for their members and guests throughout the year including a lutefisk dinner and pickled seafood contest in December.

Pick up a specialty cookbook from the bookstore, museum, Sons, or local gift shops to bring a taste of Petersburg home with you.

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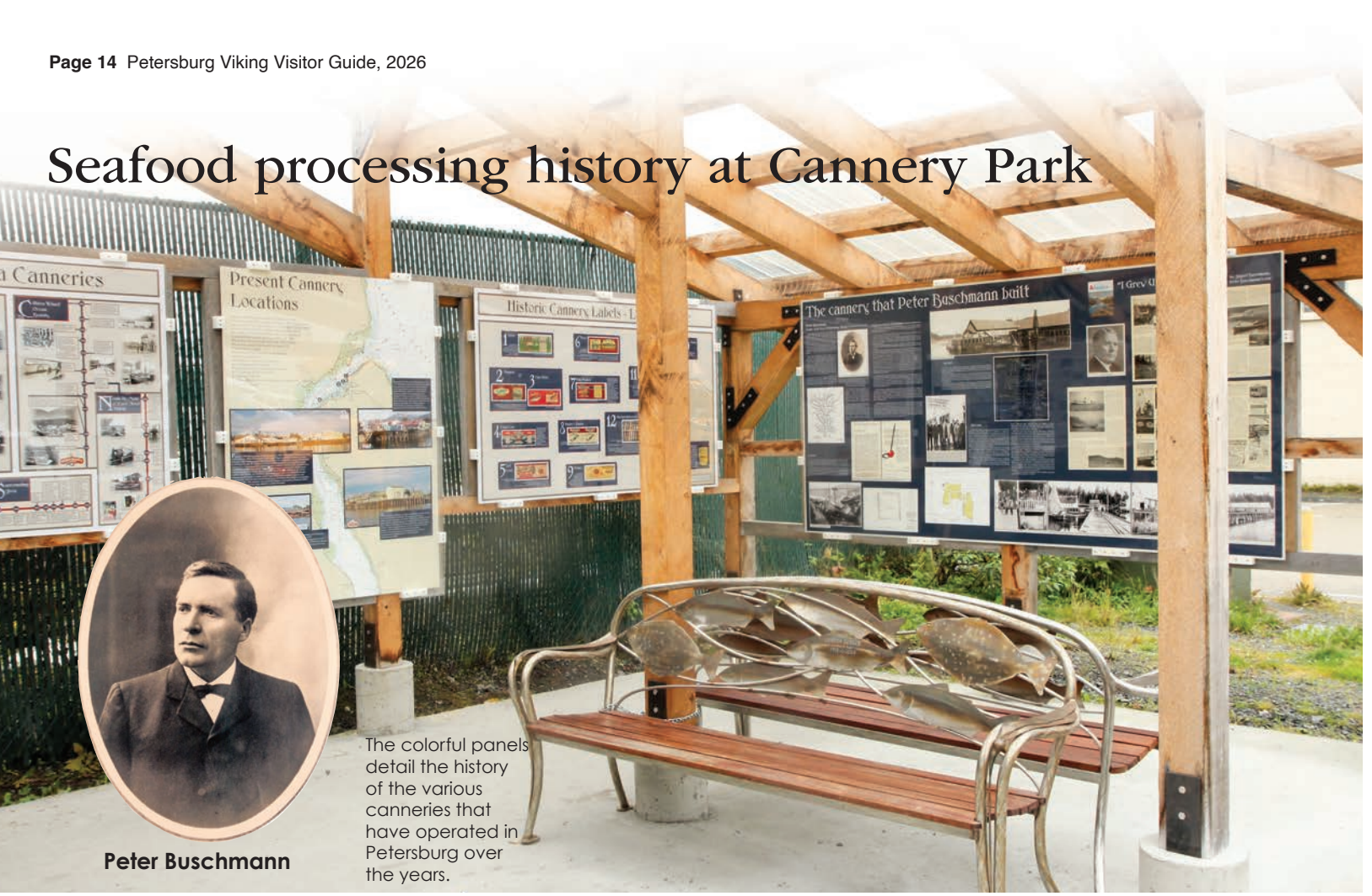
Quality Rooms

Seafood processing history at Cannery Park



Peter Buschmann

The colorful panels detail the history of the various canneries that have operated in Petersburg over the years.

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- Smartwool socks, baselayers, hats and gloves & Darn Tough socks.
- Sportswear by prAna, Kuhl, Toad & Co, Aventura, Kari Traa.
- Workout gear by Underarmour and Vuori .
- Footwear for all ages-Birkenstock, Keen, Merrell, Dansko, Sorel, Brooks, Chaco and Blundstone, Reef.
- Slippers by Haflinger, Acorn and Sorel.
- Camping Gear - Jet Boil stoves and fuel, Sea to Summit camping accessories.
- Travel Gear - Dakine luggage, Patagonia, The North Face, Cotopaxi and Fjallraven backpacks, Duffel bags, Eagle Creek luggage.
- Dry Bags by Skog Å Kust, FisheWear and Grundens.
- Hydroflask, Stanley, Nalgene water bottles.
- Alaska-designed clothing by Salmon Sisters, Ray Troll and Emma Gates.
- Xtra Tuf and Grundéns boots, deck boots and Salmon Sister Xtra Tufs.

Lee's Clothing INCORPORATED

212 Nordic Dr, Petersburg, AK • gear@leesclothing.com • (907) 772-4229 • Find us on Facebook

Cannery workers, past and present are recognized for their contribution to Petersburg's seafood industry with a covered, open air gazebo with two benches on Main Street, next to the Petersburg IGA parking lot. Panels inside the structure tell the history of Petersburg's canneries. One panel displays cannery workers throughout the years. Some are peeling shrimp by hand and others are using more modern seafood processing techniques. Another panel shows a timeline of all the canneries that have operated in Petersburg. There's also a map of the current canneries in Petersburg alongside historic labels from salmon and shrimp cans processed in town. Probably the most detailed panel shows the history of the Peter Buschmann Cannery.

Decorative metal benches were designed & produced by local welder Josef Quitslund.

Production workers have come from all over the world to work at Petersburg's various canneries, and Petersburg's Icicle Seafoods former General Manager Patrick Wilson said, "They should be recognized."

"There's usually not much mentioned about their contribution to the industry," said Wilson. Their work is often overshadowed by that of the fishermen.

Another historic cannery panel is on display at the Clausen Memorial Museum that was donated by local historian and publisher Karen Hofstad.

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Walks & hikes close to town

see maps on pages 20-21 and 22-23

FERRY TERMINAL TO TOWN

[15 minutes one way] • Easy

A left-hand turn out of the ferry terminal takes you on a quick walk to the heart of town.

On the way you'll pass the floatplane dock and South Harbor. To your left as you near town you'll see the historic Sons of Norway Hall with rosemaling on the shutters, and to the right the picturesque houses that line Hammer Slough. In town you can find many shops and restaurants.

FERRY TERMINAL TO SCOW BAY LOOP RD.

[60 minutes] • Easy

From the ferry terminal parking lot head South on S. Nordic Drive. About a mile of the walkway along the Wrangell Narrows shoreline on the scenic Coastal Bike Path.

SOUTH HARBOR LOOP

[25 minutes] • Easy

From downtown, follow Nordic Drive south over Hammer Slough toward the ferry terminal until you reach South Harbor. Enter the parking area and walk until reaching the harbor ramp. For those who have difficulty with inclines, be careful of the steep harbor ramp at low tide. This is a pleasant and short jaunt past part of the Petersburg fleet. On the way back, turn left on Sing Lee Alley to pass the Sons of Norway Hall and Sing Lee Alley, which takes you back downtown.

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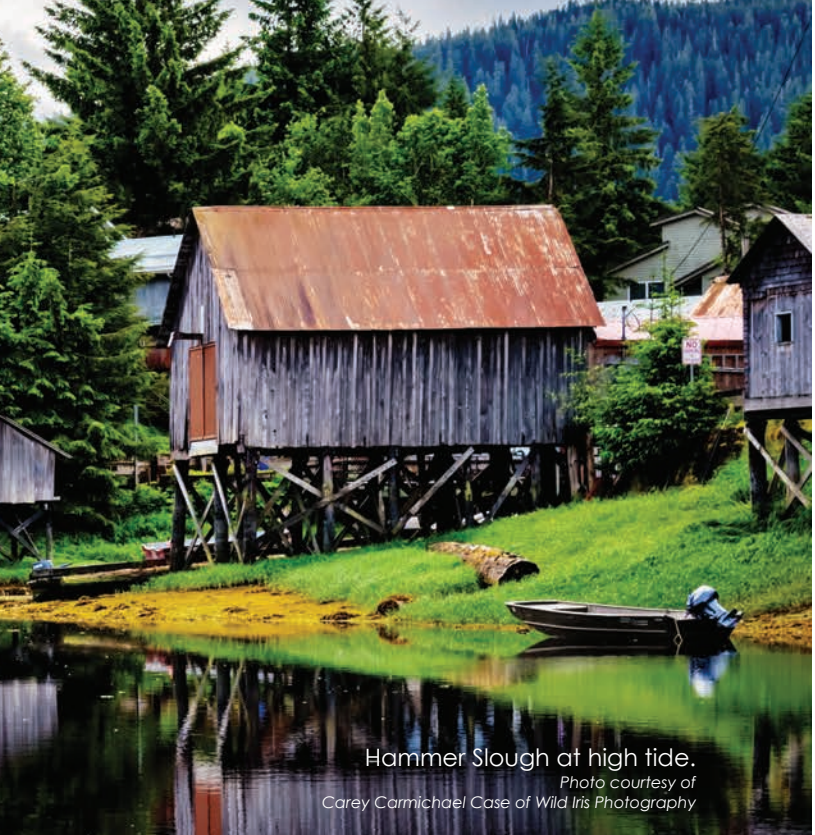

Hammer Slough at high tide.
Photo courtesy of Carey Carmichael Case of Wild Iris Photography

HAMMER SLOUGH

[10 minutes round trip] • Easy

The Birch Street boardwalk (across the street from the police department) is the first left off of Nordic Drive after Haugen Drive, if you're coming from downtown. It's a short but picturesque walk up the slough, past old homes and warehouses. Centennial Park connects to Birch Street and provides a shortcut through the trees up to the Petersburg Public Library.

THE BIG LOOP

[90 minutes] • Easy

A favorite with Petersburg walkers, this loop swings up past the airport around muskeg, with an excellent view of mountains in every direction. Head up the hill by the totem poles at the corner of Haugen and Nordic drives until you reach the walking and biking path adjacent to the road to the airport. Follow Haugen Drive all the way to Sandy Beach Park. Then turn left and take Sandy Beach Road to Nordic Drive. Follow it along the Wrangell Narrows until it takes you back downtown.

BEACH WALK

[20 minutes one way] • Easy

Past Eagle's Roost Park north of Silver Bay Seafoods along N.Nordic Dr. you can find several stairways onto the beach. At low tide, you can walk along the Wrangell Narrows to Hungry Point, where the Narrows meets Frederick Sound. Step carefully among the rocks and enjoy seeing the countless shorebirds, eagles, and other wildlife active in the tidal zone.

Petersburg Pet Center

Mon. - Fri. 10a-5:30p, Sat. 11a-2p
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Burger Night @ 5:30p

EVERY TUESDAY:
Taco Night@ 6:00p till sold out

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SECOND FRIDAY OF THE MONTH:
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Hungry Point Trails system

Hungry Point Trails system is a scenic network of hiking paths, offering stunning views of the surrounding wilderness and coastline. The trail is suitable for a range of skill levels.

Hungry Point Trail to Wrangell Narrows Loop
[40 minutes] • Easy

Hungry Point Boardwalk Loop
[30 minutes] • Easy

Mountain View Manor Boardwalk Loop
[20 or 40 minutes] • Easy

Nature Boardwalk Twelfth Street Loop
[45 minutes] • Easy

Photo courtesy of Colette Peters

Coastal Bear

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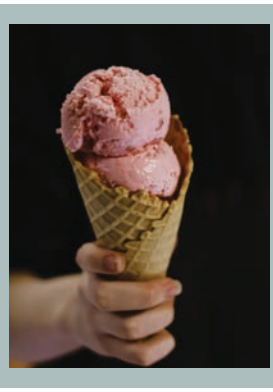

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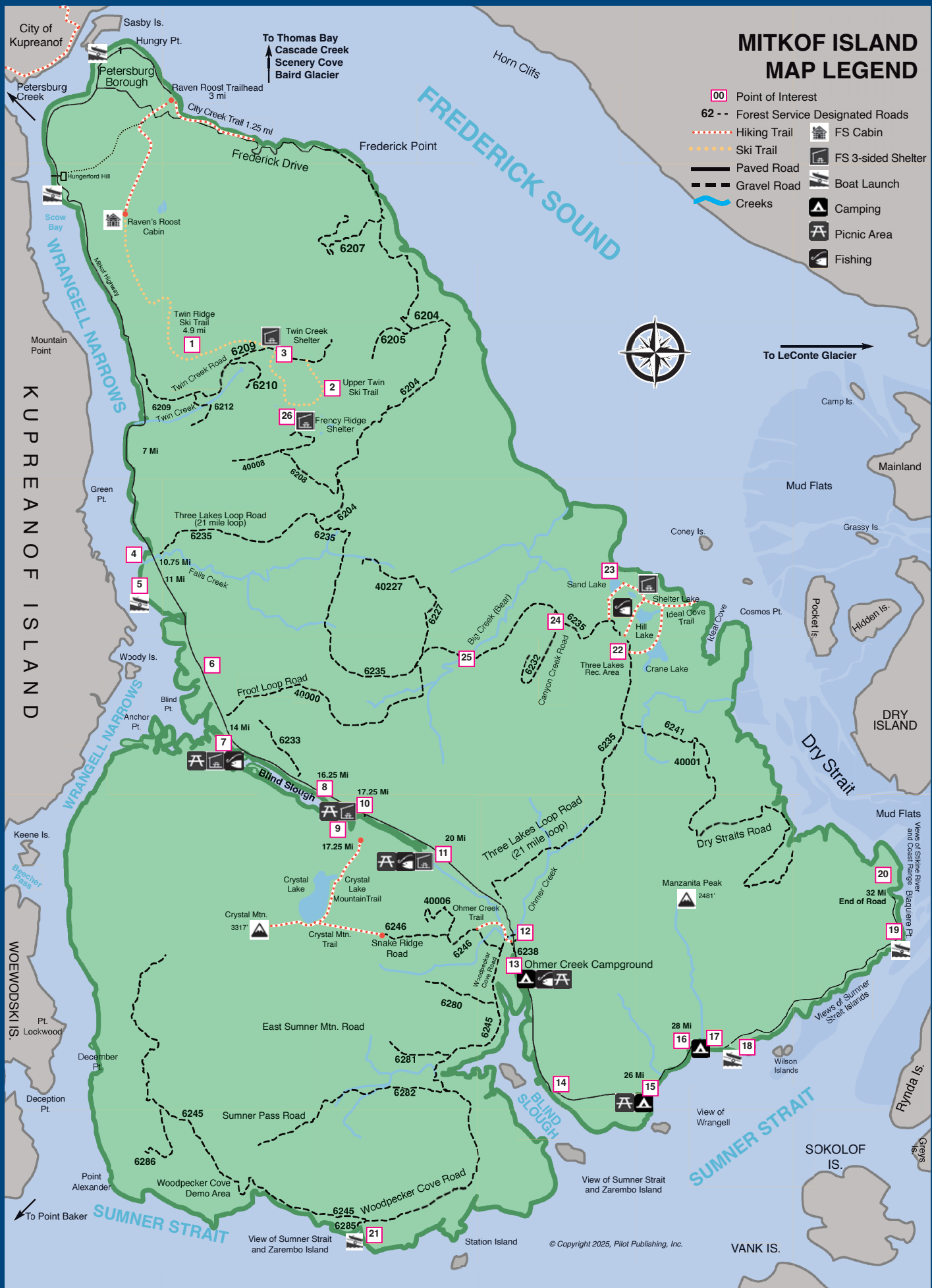
Hungry Point
Sandy Beach Rd
N
Outlook Park
Approximate Distances from
USFS Ranger District office Mile 0
12th St. & Haugen Dr.....0.5 mile
Airport Terminal ..... 0.9 mile
Sandy Beach Park .....1.6 mile
Hungry Point .....1 mile
Eagle's Roost Park ..... 0.4 mile
Ferry Terminal .....0.8 mile
Hungry Point Trail Loop 1.25mil
14th
Mort Freyer Sports Park
Mountain View Manor Boardwalk Trail, 0.25mil
Frederick Sound
William Musson Trail
PMC Wellness, Education & Resource Center
Hallingstad Peratrovich Center
Bike Path
Fire Hall
Post Office
Haugen Dr.
James A. Johnson Airport
Petroglyphs
Sandy Beach Park
City Creek Trailhead
1.25 mil
Bike Park
Dog Park
Raven Trailhead
3 mil
Frederick Dr

- Totem Locations
- Public Bathrooms
- Picnic Table
- Parking
- Playground
- Ballfields
- School
- Community Gym
- Pool
- Chamber of Commerce and Visitor Information Center
- USFS Ranger District Office
- Shopping
- Police
- Library

1. Sons of Norway Hall and Sing Lee Alley Area
2. Bojer Wikan Fishermen's Memorial Park
3. Alaska Fish & Game Office
4. Municipal Building & Police Station
5. Harbor Master Office
6. E.C. Phillips & Son Inc. Seafood Processor
7. Cannery Park
8. Buschmann Historical Marker
9. Silver Bay Seafoods
10. Eagle's Roost Park
11. Federal Building
12. Petersburg Public Library
13. John Hanson Sr. Hall
14. Chamber of Commerce and Visitor Information Center
15. Clausen Memorial Museum and Museum Store and "The Fisk"
16. Hallingstad Peratrovich Center
17. Public Health Office
18. Wright Auditorium
19. Petersburg Medical Center
20. Petersburg Lutheran Church


MITKOF ISLAND
MAP LEGEND
00 Point of Interest
62 - - Forest Service Designated Roads
Hiking Trail
Ski Trail
Paved Road
Gravel Road
Creeks
FS Cabin
FS 3-sided Shelter
Boat Launch
Camping
Picnic Area
Fishing
To Thomas Bay
Cascade Creek
Scenery Cove
Baird Glacier
To LeConte Glacier
City of Kupreanof
Sasby Is.
Hungry Pt.
Petersburg Borough
Petersburg Creek
Raven Roost Trailhead 3 mi
City Creek Trail 1.25 mi
Frederick Drive
Frederick Point
Horn Cliffs
FREDERICK SOUND
Hungerford Hill
Scow Bay
Raven's Roost Cabin
WRANGELL NARROWS
Mitkof Highway
KUPREANOF ISLAND
Twin Ridge Ski Trail 4.9 mi
Twin Creek Shelter
Twin Creek Road
Upper Twin Ski Trail
Frency Ridge Shelter
Mountain Point
Green Pt.
Three Lakes Loop Road (21 mile loop)
Falls Creek
Woody Is.
Froot Loop Road
Blind Pt.
Anchor Pt.
Blind Slough
Keene Is.
Beecher Pass
Crystal Lake
Crystal Lake MountainTrail
Crystal Mtn.
Crystal Mtn. Trail
Snake Ridge Road
Ohmer Creek Trail
Ohmer Creek Campground
Ohmer Creek
Woodpecker Cove Road
East Sumner Mtn. Road
Sumner Pass Road
Woodpecker Cove Demo Area
Point Alexander
WOEWODSKI IS.
Pt. Lockwood
December Pt.
Deception Pt.
To Point Baker
SUMNER STRAIT
View of Sumner Strait and Zarembo Island
Station Island
Camp Is.
Mainland
Mud Flats
Coney Is.
Grassy Is.
Sand Lake
Shelter Lake
Ideal Cove Trail
Hill Lake
Three Lakes Rec. Area
Crane Lake
Canyon Creek Road
Big Creek (Bear)
Cosmos Pt.
Pocket Is.
Hidden Is.
DRY ISLAND
Dry Strait
Dry Straits Road
Manzanita Peak
2481'
Views of Stikine River and Coast Range
Blaquiere Pt.
32 Mi End of Road
Wilson Islands
Rynda Is.
Views of Sumner Strait Islands
View of Wrangell
SUMNER STRAIT
SOKOLOF IS.
Greys Is.
View of Sumner Strait and Zarembo Island
BLIND SLOUGH
VANK IS.
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Points of Interest Out the Road

***Bear spray recommended.**

1. Twin Ridge Ski Trail: 4.9 mile
2. Upper Twin Ski Trail
3. Twin Creek Shelter
4. * Falls Creek Fish Ladder: 10.75 mile
5. Papke's Landing: 11 mile
6. Petersburg Shooting Range: 13 mile
7. * Blind River Rapids Boardwalk: 14 mile,
Toilets, Fishing, Wildlife viewing
8. Swan Observatory: 16.25 mile
Wildlife viewing
9. * Crystal Lake Fish Hatchery: 17.25 mile
10. * Blind Slough Rec. Area: 17.25 mile
Picnic Area, Water activities, Toilets
11. * Manmade Hole Picnic Ground: 20 mil
12. * Ohmer Creek Trail: 21.5 mile
13. * Ohmer Creek Campground: 22 mile
14. South Mitkof Ferry Terminal: 25 mile
15. Green's Camp Public Use Area: 26 mile,
Picnic Area, Camp Sites, Toilets
16. Crescent Beach: 28 mile
17. Wilson Creek Rec. Area: 28 mile
Picnic Area, Camp Sites, Toilets
18. Banana Point: 28 mile,
Toilets, Boat Launch
19. Blaquiere Point: 32.9 mile
Toilet, Boat Launch, Picnic Area
20. End of Road: 33.8 mile
21. * Woodpecker Cove: 21.5 mile
22. * Three Lakes Rec. Area: 21 mile, Loop
23. Three Lakes Shelter: 15 mile
24. LeConte Glacier Overlook
25. Big Creek Bridge (Bear Creek)
26. Frenchy Ridge Shelter

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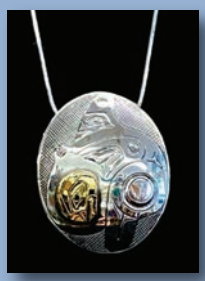
- ✔ Whale Sculptures



Alaskan Gifts

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Eagle & Raven totems

In 2000 Sitka totem pole artist Tommy Joseph was commissioned to carve two 35-foot tall healing totems that now stand at the corner of Haugen and Nordic Drives.

The totems, Eagle and Raven, represent the two distinct kinship groups, or moieties, that divide Tlingit society. Each moiety is further broken down into individual clans. All of the clans in Petersburg are displayed on the two poles at the site.

One element of the Raven pole also honors an important local geographic feature — Devil's Thumb — while other portions of the pole display parts of the post-flooding migration story with Man in Canoe and Stikine River.

The Petersburg Eagle and Raven poles were raised on October 7, 2001 and were carved in recognition of the Tlingit contribution to the prosperity and diversity of the town and to represent a link between ancestors and descendants.

Joseph also carved the 20 foot Storyteller's Pole which was raised in 2018 outside the Petersburg Public Library.

Photo courtesy of Kaylee Earll

The Hutli Project at Sandy Beach Park

Hutli Totem Pole

When visiting Petersburg take time to explore the Hutli Project at Sandy Beach Park. Hutli, the Tlingit word for Thunderbird and the thundering sound of its wings, refers to Thunder Bay (Xeitl Geeyi'), also known as LeConte Bay, where glacier calving creates thunderous echoes.

As you walk through the plaza, you'll discover interpretive panels that tell the story of Indigenous presence through four themes: arrival, fish traps, petroglyphs, and shell middens.

The signs highlight archaeological evidence in the Sandy Beach Park area that spans millennia: shell middens lie beneath your feet, petroglyphs are visible nearby, and ancient fish traps can be spotted offshore.

The centerpiece of the plaza is the Hutli story pole,carved by Tlingit artist Fred Fulmer Sr. Topped with the thunderbird (Hutli), the pole features carvings of salmon, harbor seal, killer whale, wolf, and halibut—creatures central to Tlingit life and culture.

The Hutli Project extends beyond the plaza through the newly expanded City Creek Trail. Future plans include twelve additional interpretive signs along the boardwalk portion, creating an immersive story walk experience that further celebrates the enduring legacy of the Séet Ká Kwáan.

4 signs about Petersburg's Indigenous population

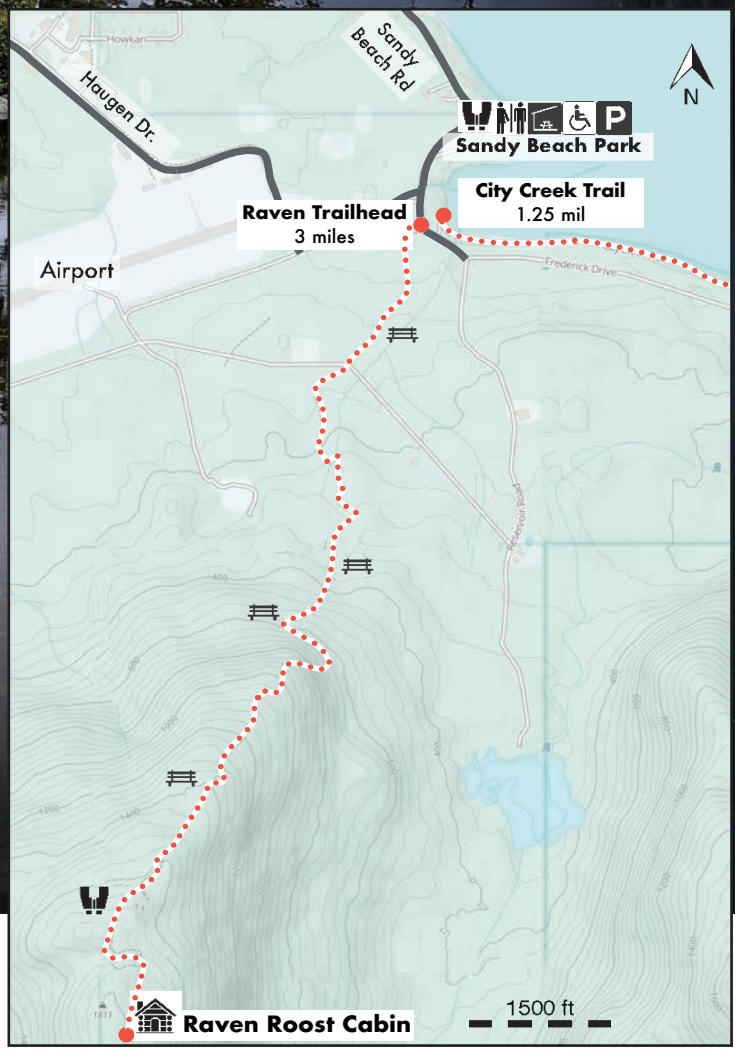
Sandy Beach to City Creek Trail

[1 hour round trip] • Easy (some mobility necessary to step up and down)

The Sandy Beach to City Creek Trail was extended in 2024 through the generosity of the Petersburg Indian Association. This newly improved, mile-long pathway features both gravel sections and a stunning 2,000-foot boardwalk with panoramic views of Frederick Sound. Perfect for birdwatching and nature appreciation, the trail connects Sandy Beach Park to City Creek, with access to

Raven Trail *[3 hours one way] • Strenuous*

The trail can be accessed by a trailhead across the from Sandy Beach Park. The beginning of the Raven Trail is gravel for a distance of 1/2-mile and connects to a Borough Service Road. Across the service road, the trail continues for another 2.5 miles. A portion of the trail is boardwalk, and other parts have somewhat steep sections that are a good workout. The view from the top offers outstanding views of Petersburg, Frederick Sound and Wrangell Narrows. The Trail accesses the Raven's Roost Cabin at an elevation of 1,745 feet.



the beach along the way.

The eight-foot-wide path accommodates visitors of all abilities, with additional parking available off Frederick Point Road. Future plans include a loop trail option returning from City Creek.

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September 10-13, 2026

Walks and Hikes "Out the Road"

Take your own vehicle or rent one and journey south out the road to experience the largest temperate rainforest in the world and many other attractions on Mitkof Island. The first Mitkof Highway mile marker is located just beyond the Ferry Terminal parking lot and the first mile is measured from Wells Fargo Bank downtown.
Cell service may be limited outside of downtown Petersburg.

BLIND RIVER RAPIDS BOARDWALK

[30 minutes round trip], EASY 14 miles from town

Located on Mitkof Highway, this Accessible trail leads to one of the most popular fishing spots in the area.

The trailhead sign is highly visible from the road. A large parking lot can accommodate motor homes. The boardwalk to the rapids is approximately one-quarter-mile long, and the loop is one-half-mile. The trail passes through a muskeg bog before reaching the popular fishing hole at the rapids.

Restrooms are provided near the parking lot, and a shelter is available near the trail's end.

Species:

- **Black Bear**
- **Chickadees**
- **Chinook (King) Salmon**
- **Coho (Silver) Salmon**
- **Eagles**
- **Moose**
- **Pink (Humpy) Salmon**
- **Sitka black-tailed deer**
- **Woodpeckers**

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MAP LEGEND:

- Highway
- Gravel Road
- Boardwalk
- Hiking Trail
- Fishing Spot
- Picnic Area with Shelter
- Bench
- Picnic Table
- Restrooms
- Accessible
- Parking
- Cabin
- Wildlife viewing
- Swimming
- Boating Non-Motorized
- Camping

Photo courtesy of Carey Carmichael Case of Wild Iris Photography

Five Finger Lighthouse Society, a nonprofit organization

Five Finger Lighthouse Society, a small nonprofit, is working towards upgrading and renovating the facility to yield improved access to the structure for posterity.

For several months out of the year, volunteer lighthouse keepers live onsite to keep the structure in good shape, and provide hospitality to guests who arrive via boat and helicopter.

Guests are granted a tour of the lighthouse, including a stunning, panoramic views from the cupola 60 feet above the island's bedrock, and the primitive trail to the picturesque south end of the island.

Learn more about the lighthouse, and donate to support preservation efforts. Scan the QR code, or visit www.fivefingerlighthouse.com.

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SWAN OBSERVATORY, WILDLIFE VIEWING SITE • 16.25 miles from town

Located at Mile 16 of Mitkof Highway, the wheelchair-accessible observatory was constructed in 2008. The building provides a shielded place to view trumpeter swans, some of which winter on Mitkof Island. Though dozens of swans overwinter here, countless more of these large waterfowl stop here between mid-October and early December to rest and feed before continuing their migratory journey to the south. Be careful not to disturb the resting swans. Bears and salmon also may be seen during the summer downriver from the Swan Observatory in the shallow waters.

Photo courtesy of Jenny Annett Jenny Annett Photography

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BLIND SLOUGH RECREATION AREA

• 17.25 miles from town

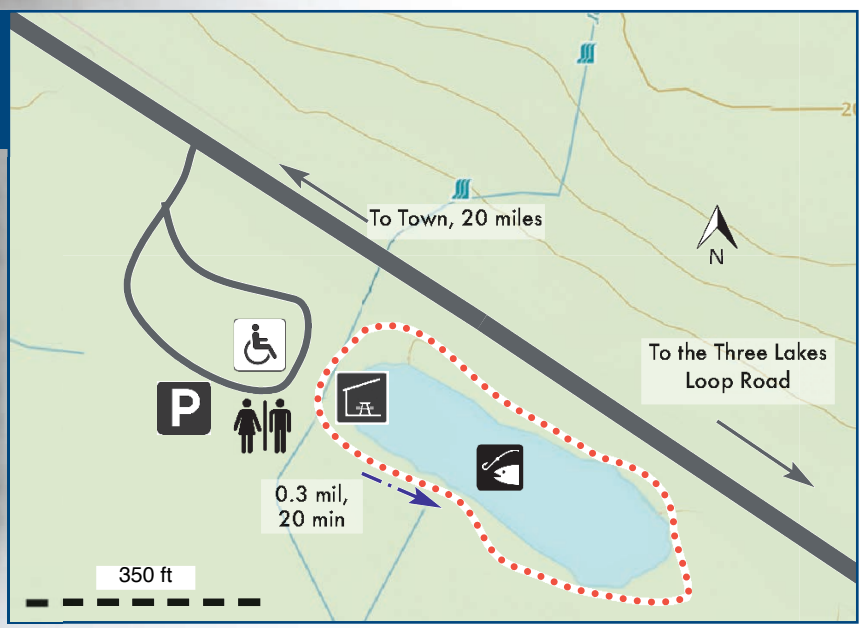
The Blind Slough Picnic Area includes two large shelters, a smaller, accessible shelter, and two vault toilets that are available for group and individual day use. The area accesses Blind Slough for fishing (salmon and trout), swimming, kayaking, and small boating, as well as ice skating in the winter.

Blind Slough Picnic Area has a small boat ramp where kayaks and canoes can launch. Boating northwest leads to saltwater, and southeast leads to an array of beaver ponds.

MANMADE HOLE PICNIC GROUND

[20 minutes] • EASY
• 20 miles from town

Enjoy a quiet stroll in the woods around the swimming hole off Mitkof Highway at mile 20. Accessible restroom and a picnic shelter are available. The lake near the picnic area is available for swimming during the summer months. Trout fishing is available right at the picnic site, or the trail can access spots across the pond.



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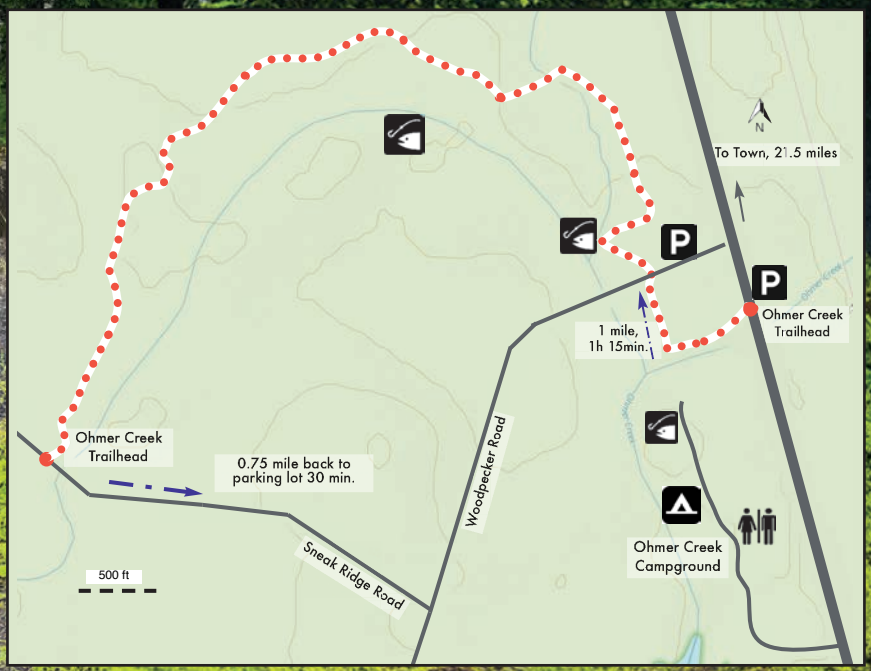
OHMER CREEK TRAIL, [1 hour] from Woodpecker Road Trailhead to Snake Ridge Road

• EASY TO MODERATE • 21.5 miles from town



This one-mile trail is adjacent to the Ohmer Creek Campground, and follows Ohmer Creek through spruce and hemlock forest to a floating bridge over a beaver pond.

The first quarter-mile of the trail is wheelchair-accessible and accesses a fishing platform and the second part of the trail is plank and native tread.

The trail provides anglers with access to the creek and adjacent ponds,providing fair to good trout and salmon fishing in late summer and fall.

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How to get there:

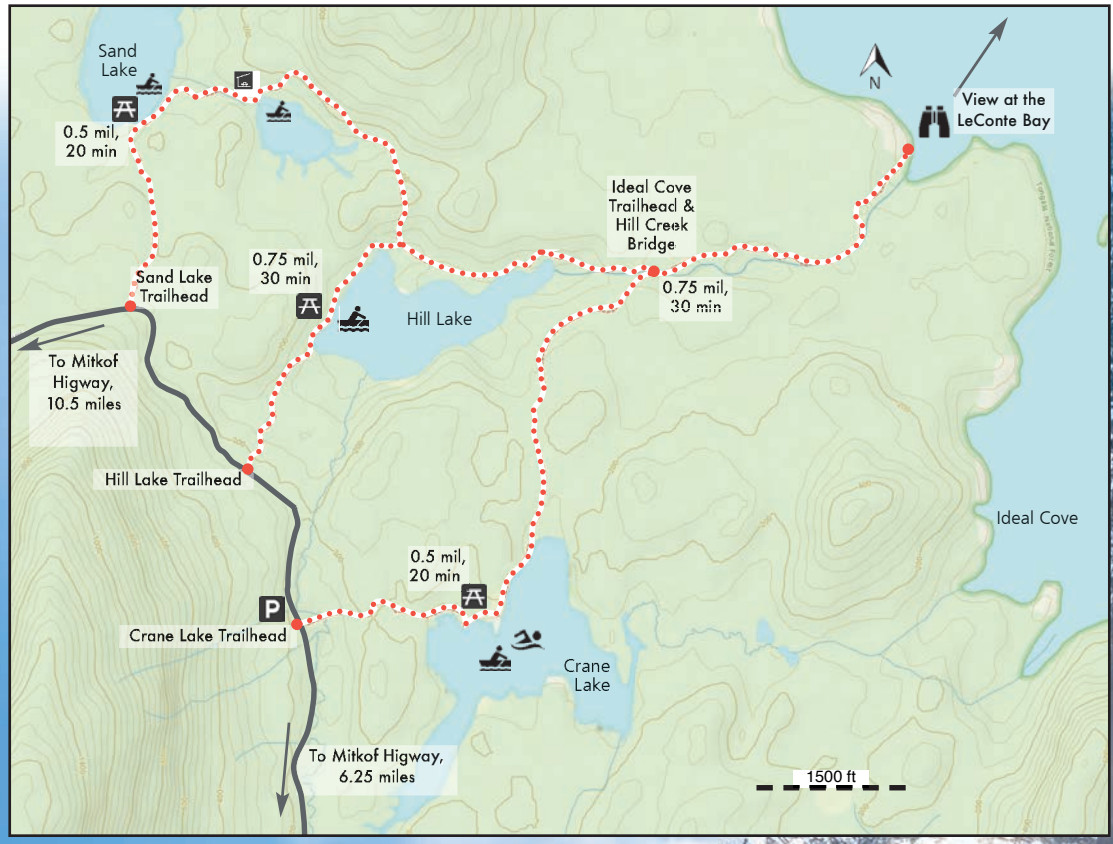
To get there, drive past Crystal Lake Hatchery, past Man-made Hole, and take the first left onto Three Lakes Loop Road.

The total length of the Three Lakes trails and Ideal Cove Trail is about 5.4 miles. The Three Lakes Trail system has trailheads at the beginning of the Sand, Hill, and Crane trails. They are all located off of the Three Lakes Loop Road.

THE CRANE LAKE TRAIL is 1.5 miles long. It begins at the trailhead on the Three Lakes Loop Road and ends at the junction with Ideal Cove and Hill Lake Trails.

THE HILL LAKE TRAIL is 1.3 miles long. Nice views of Hill Lake and surrounding forest and muskeg.

Shelter Lake Trail is 0.75 mile long with a three-sided Adirondack-style shelter between Sand and Hill Lakes along the Three Lakes Loop Trail. The shelter was rebuilt in the mid-2000's and is available for day use.



THE SAND LAKE TRAIL is 1.4 miles long. It begins at the junction with Hill Lake Trail and ends at the trailhead on the Three Lakes Loop Road.

Wildflowers and berries abound along most of the trail and all four lakes offer trout fishing. Rowboats, fishing platforms, and picnic tables are available at all three lakes.

The Ideal Cove trail is 0.75 miles long. It begins at the Hill Creek bridge and ends 1/4 mile north of Ideal Cove.

Hikes off the Island: Kupreanof Island

The City of Kupreanof is located on Lindenberg Peninsula on the North Shore of Kupreanof island. It is a road-less community by ordinance and basically maintains an individual subsistence lifestyle.

Wild creatures are abundant, so for your safety give the larger animals the right of way.

Kupreanof is the Gateway into the Petersburg Creek Wilderness.

Enjoy your visit and please remember to carry out what you carry in.

For more information call 907-340-2400 or visit www.cityofkupreanof.org

PETERSBURG MOUNTAIN TRAIL:

- 3.5 miles from State Dock • DIFFICULT
- [8 hours round trip]

To get across the Narrows, you need a boat ride or kayak. On the Kupreanof side, head right on the overgrown road toward Sasby Island.

The first mile is an easy walk through the community of Kupreanof. The trail climbs fairly steeply for the next 2.5 miles to the saddle.

The last quarter-mile is a very steep scramble over rocks to the 2,750-foot summit, which provides one of the best views of Petersburg, the Coast Mountains, glaciers and Wrangell Narrows.

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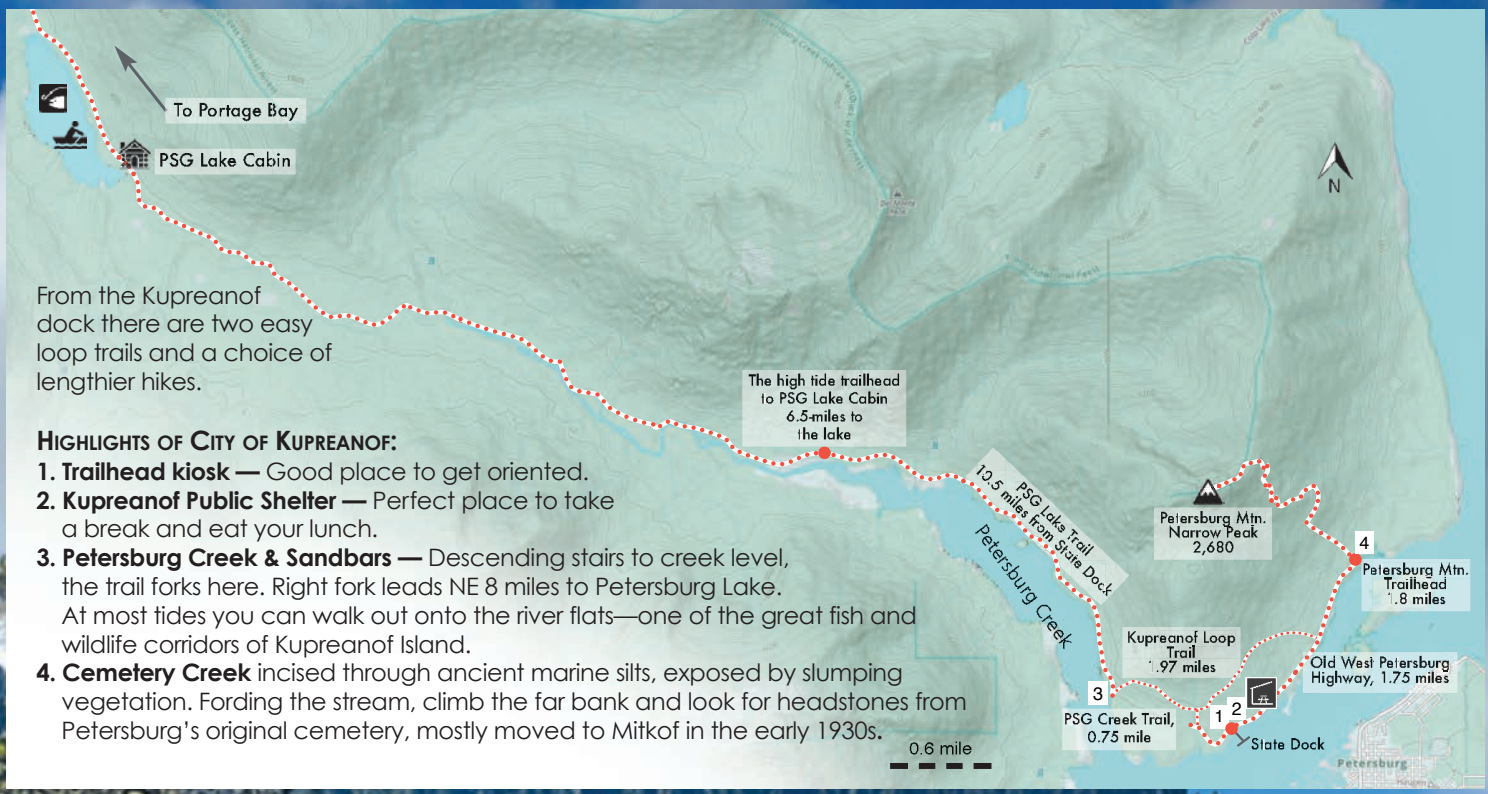


HIGHLIGHTS OF CITY OF KUPREANOF:

1. **Trailhead kiosk —** Good place to get oriented.
2. **Kupreanof Public Shelter —** Perfect place to take a break and eat your lunch.
3. **Petersburg Creek & Sandbars —** Descending stairs to creek level, the trail forks here. Right fork leads NE 8 miles to Petersburg Lake. At most tides you can walk out onto the river flats—one of the great fish and wildlife corridors of Kupreanof Island.
4. **Cemetery Creek** incised through ancient marine silts, exposed by slumping vegetation. Fording the stream, climb the far bank and look for headstones from Petersburg's original cemetery, mostly moved to Mitkof in the early 1930s.

PETERSBURG LAKE TRAIL:

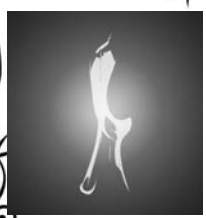
• 10.5 miles from State Dock • DIFFICULT • [8-12 hours]

Hikers have a choice of getting onto the board-walk trail at two separate locations: Kupreanof State Dock trailhead for a 10.5-mile hike, or the high tide trailhead up Petersburg Creek for a 6.5-mile hike. Both trails follow the creek, with access to trout and salmon fishing, wildflower meadows and great opportunities for photographers.

The Petersburg Lake Trail construction is primitive and sometimes difficult to locate due to mud and brush.

******* Hikers are advised to contact the Petersburg Ranger District to check on trail conditions prior to hiking.***

The Petersburg Lake Cabin, located at the end of the hike is available for rent from the Petersburg Ranger District and also be reached by float plane.



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Hikes & Attractions off the Island: *Thomas Bay Area*

Thomas Bay is a bay located in Southeast Alaska. It lies northeast of Petersburg. Thomas Bay is also known as "The Bay of Death" due to a massive landslide in 1750. It also gained the name of "Devil's Country" several people claimed to have seen devil creatures in the area in 1900.

Thomas Bay is known for being rich in gold and quartz.

The wildlife of the area includes moose, brown bears, black bears, squirrels, wolves, rabbits, and other common Alaskan creatures. The land in the area has been used for logging.

Photo courtesy of Danielle MacPhee

CASCADE CREEK TRAIL

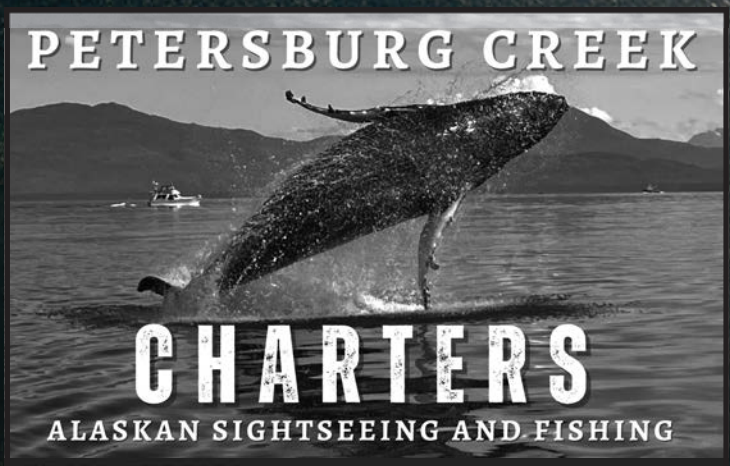
• 4.1 mile •DIFFICULT •[6-8 hours]

The trail leaves Cascade Creek Cabin through forest, then follows the shoreline to the tidewater trailhead located 0.25 miles from the cabin.

From the beach the trail follows Cascade Creek 0.25 miles to the lower falls; as it continues up the creek it gets more difficult to hike. A bridge spans the creek at the 0.25 mile point and continues upslope along the opposite side of the creek. This portion is more difficult to hike as it ascends rapidly and has more primitive development.

About 2.5 miles from the cabin trailhead you will reach Falls Lake. You can row the boat provided to the upper or east end of the lake where the trail leads to Falls Lake Shelter and on up to the Cascade Creek Trail. The main trail crosses a small lake, then follows Cascade Creek for 1 mile to the Swan Lake trailhead. The three-sided Adirondack-style shelter at Falls Lake is for day or overnight use and there is no fee.

A landslide between the Falls Lake Shelter and Swan Lake has made a portion of the trail more difficult to pass.



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Alaska's first lighthouse

Photo courtesy of Stephanie Hayes

On a three-acre island 45 miles north of Petersburg, sits the Five Finger Lighthouse. It was the first lighthouse built in Alaska and last one fully manned. Located at the confluence of Stephens Passage and Frederick Sound, the historic Five Finger Lighthouse stands 68 feet tall.

The Five Finger Lighthouse was built in 1902 and was initially operated by the US Lighthouse Service with a lighthouse keeper and an assistant living there for years on end, until the United States Coast Guard took over duties and deployed six-person crews for 365 day assignments.

The original wooden structure burned down in 1935, but the lighthouse was rebuilt from concrete.

The USCG operated the lighthouse until 1984 when the light went fully automated. Now the lighthouse is maintained by the Five Finger Lighthouse Society (FFLS), a small nonprofit based out of Petersburg.

Because of the remote location of the lighthouse, it can sometimes be hard to access. Rocks surround the island, and winds can pick up to storm-force speeds in the open waters to the west of the island.

Several months out of the year, lighthouse keepers volunteering with Five Finger Lighthouse Society live onsite. The lighthouse keeper works to maintain the lighthouse and greet visitors. When the flag is flying and the seas are calm, the lighthouse can be hailed by VHF and the lighthouse keeper can show visitors around. "Our objective as an organization is to preserve and maintain the historic structure and to make the site accessible to the public in order to increase the awareness of the significance and educational value of the Five Finger Lighthouse," said Thomas Cumps, former president of the FFLS board.

In recent years, several whale research organizations have made use of the facility as a base of operation for scientific research.

Anyone wanting more information about the lighthouse or wanting to donate to support preservation efforts can visit fivefingerlighthouse.com.

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Area waters ideal for humpbacks

One of the best places in the world for viewing

By Kelly Bakos

Photo courtesy of Stephanie Hayes

The marine ecosystem around Petersburg is rich with plankton and fish making it an ideal summer feeding ground for migratory humpback whales. Of the estimated 22,000 humpback whales in the North Pacific, approximately 5,000 – 7,000 spend the summer feeding in Southeast Alaska. Nearly half of those may pass through and feed in Frederick Sound before taking the 2,800 mile journey back to Hawaii in the fall for the birth of their calves. This makes Frederick Sound one of the best places in the world for observing humpback whales.

With the waters prolific with marine activity, researchers, wildlife photographers, and eco-tourists travel here to view and study these creatures. The Petersburg Marine Mammal Center (PMMC) is a non-profit organization providing a link between the environment and the community.

PMMC responds to local reports of stranded marine mammals as an authorized responder of NOAA Fisheries' Alaska Marine Mammal Stranding Network.

PMMC's volunteers are trained to respond to a variety of situations whether it is injury, entanglement, disease, exposure to contaminants, or disorientation, and have special equipment for disentangling 40-ton free-swimming whales from marine debris.

If you see a stranded or entangled marine mammal, do not attempt to move, feed, or approach the animal. Oftentimes, animals that appear to be distressed are actually displaying normal behavior. Whales may quietly rest on the surface for long periods of time. Marine mammals are protected under the Marine Mammal Protection Act, and it is illegal to disturb, approach, or handle marine mammals.

But if a marine mammal is found sick, injured or dead, reporting the stranding is the best way to help the distressed animal. Take photos from a safe distance and record as much information as you can. Please report the event by calling the Alaska Stranding Hotline at 1-877-925-7773.

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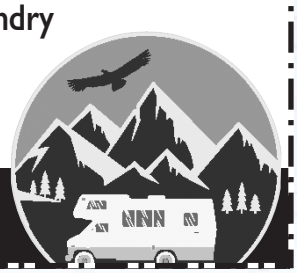

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Discover LeConte Glacier

LeConte Glacier is one of Southeast Alaska's most dramatic natural landmarks and holds the distinction of being the southernmost tidewater glacier in the Northern Hemisphere. Located in Petersburg Borough, the glacier flows roughly 21 miles from the Stikine Icefield through a steep mountain valley before terminating in the deep waters of LeConte Bay.

As a tidewater glacier, LeConte calves ice directly into the ocean, producing frequent and sometimes thunderous icefalls. Thunder Bay (Xeitl Geeyi') is the area's original Tlingit name.

The bay's exceptional depth—over 800 feet in places—creates a rare phenomenon known as "shooter icebergs," where submerged ice chunks break free and rocket upward to the surface. These dramatic events make the glacier a popular destination for boat tours and a valuable site for scientific research.

The glacier has retreated about 2.5 miles since it was first mapped, though in recent decades it has shown periods of relative stability. Modern studies reveal that much of its melting occurs below the waterline, offering important insights into how warming oceans affect tidewater glaciers.

Beyond its scientific importance, LeConte Glacier plays a key ecological role. Its icy waters provide habitat for marine life, including harbor seals, and its striking scenery has become a signature attraction for visitors to the region.

Photo courtesy of Carey Carmichael Case of Wild Iris Photography

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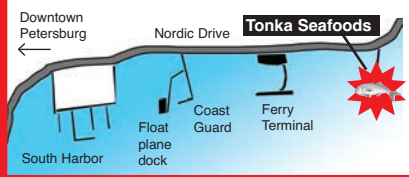

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Where to camp

Ohmer Creek Campground

Located 22 miles south of Petersburg on Mitkof Highway, this Forest Service campground has 10 sites suitable for tents or trailers up to 32-feet long, but services including waste disposal and water are no longer provided. Campers should provide their own contained waste system and bring water. No fee.

The campground is set along a trout and salmon fishing stream. Fishing is permitted but licenses are required.

Green's Camp

A favorite location for family picnics and beachcombing, this campground is directly on saltwater 26 miles from Petersburg on Mitkof Highway. 30 campsites, four picnic areas and multiple restrooms are available.

Wilson Creek Recreation Area

At Mile 27.9 Mitkof Highway, this area has tables, outhouses and turnarounds for trailers.

CABIN RENTALS:

Eighteen Forest Service cabins are available to rent on the Petersburg Ranger District. Most cabins are accessible by boat or floatplane only. Contact charter air companies in town if you plan on flying to a cabin.

Each cabin includes tables, benches, bunks (without mattresses), wood or oil stoves (not suitable for cooking, bring your own fuel), an ax, a broom and an outhouse.

Cabins can be reserved through the National Recreation Reservation Service at Recreation.gov. Information and assistance with cabin reservations can be found at the Petersburg Visitor Center, the Petersburg Ranger District office.

Kah Sheets Lake Cabin

Located on Kupreanof Island, the Kah Sheets Lake Cabin is approachable by floatplane. Rowboats are provided at the cabin.

A 2.5-mile plank trail connects the lake cabin to Kah Sheets Bay Cabin. The trail also accesses the creek for steelhead and coho fishing, and views of the falls.

The cabin, picnic platform, and outhouse all meet barrier-free standards. The cabin sleeps seven people.

West Point Cabin

This impressive modified A-frame is located on the northern end of Kupreanof Island. The cabin, trail and outhouse are wheelchair-accessible.

The cabin also provides access to excellent beach hiking, saltwater fishing for king and silver salmon and viewing of whales in Frederick Sound. The cabin sleeps six people.

Located on Kupreanof Island in the Petersburg Creek-Duncan Salt Chuck Wilderness, the Petersburg Lake Cabin is accessible by a short boat ride or kayak paddle across the Wrangell Narrows followed by a hike or by floatplane.

Petersburg Lake is ice-free from April through November.

The hike can begin from the Kupreanof State Dock or is accessible four miles up Petersburg Creek by boat or kayak. The hike is 10.5 miles from the state dock and 6.5 miles from the upper trail.

The pan-abode style cabin sleeps six and is heated with a wood stove. A rowboat is available at the lake.

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The Castle Flats Cabin lies on the edge of the mud flats of the Castle River in Duncan Canal. It is 30 minutes by air and 30 miles by boat from Petersburg. A 15-foot high tide is required for a plane to land or a 13-foot tide for a boat to anchor next to the cabin. Water is available from a small creek west of the cabin.

Good silver salmon fishing runs throughout August.

The tidal flats in front of the cabin make this a particularly good site for bird watching. A rowboat is provided at the cabin. The Castle River Trail connects the flats cabin with the Castle River Cabin and accesses the upper rowboat. The cabin sleeps four people.

Cascade Creek Cabin

Thomas Bay is located northeast of Petersburg. The Baird Glacier drains into the bay. The Cascade Creek hunter style cabin has a wood stove, and oil heater (#1 stove oil only), 2 double bunks, 2 single bunks, counter, wooden table and benches, covered porch, axe/maul, and pit-type outhouse. Stove oil, bedding, and cooking utensils are not provided. Firewood is available for wood stove use only, but is not guaranteed. The area in front of the cabin is flat. Forested slopes directly behind the cabin become steeper with elevation gain, eventually rising to Cosmos Peak at 5,000 feet.

The 4.1-mile long Cascade Creek Trail connects the Cascade Creek Cabin to the shelter at Falls Lake, and the south end of Swan Lake.

Raven's Roost Cabin

The cabin has wooden bunks on the main floor and a sleeping loft.

It is equipped with a covered deck, a table and benches, a propane heater and an outhouse with a pit toilet.

See page 27 about Raven Trail.

Swan Lake Cabin

This A-frame cabin constructed in 2005, is one of the district's most popular. Be sure to make cabin reservations early.

Swan Lake is an alpine lake at 1,514 feet above sea level on the mainland east of Thomas Bay. The lake is accessible by a 30-minute plane ride from Petersburg.

The cabin is surrounded by the steep peaks of the Coast Range, offering some spectacular scenery and photo opportunities. The steep slopes are home to mountain goats and alpine flowers.

Special cabin features include two rowboats and a boathouse. The cabin sleeps five people.

RVs are welcome

Petersburg welcomes RV guests and has two private parks to accommodate their visits.

RV parking is available at the Ohmer Creek campground, operated by the U.S. Forest Service. Ohmer Creek has limited maintenance and no water or bathrooms. Recreational vehicles can find legal parking on most streets as long as posted signs are obeyed.

A water and service station is located at N. 3rd St. off Wrangell Ave., behind the community gym and aquatic facility.

Contact the front desk at Parks & Rec to pay fee .

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Wildlife viewing tips

Dawn and dusk are the best viewing times: If you arrive early or stay late, you are likely to see more wildlife.

Learn feeding habits: Many shorebirds, marine birds and waterfowl follow the tides during their feeding cycle. Other wildlife such as bears, spend large amounts of time during the summer near salmon streams and berry patches.

Blend-in: Wear natural colors and unscented lotions. Hide behind vegetation and rocks.

Look for sign: Tracks in the mud and snow, unusual scents, scat and browsed vegetation provide evidence of wildlife in the area. Use these clues to locate animals.

Be patient: Allow enough time. Even in Alaska, where wildlife is abundant, it can take years, if not a lifetime, to see all the species.

Don't get too close: Give wildlife plenty of space. Binoculars and spotting scopes allow you to view wildlife without getting too close.

Approach wildlife slowly and quietly. Allow animals a route to escape.

View without changing behavior: Avoid using calls or devices that attract wildlife. Don't throw rocks to make birds fly. Harassing wildlife is illegal.

Be respectful: Nests, denning areas, rookeries and calving grounds are sensitive areas. Intrusive visitors may cause parents to flee, leaving young vulnerable to the elements or predators. Stay on designated trails.

Leave "orphaned" or sick animals alone: Young animals left alone usually have parents waiting nearby.

Don't feed the animals: Don't get wildlife hooked on handouts. Some foods may even harm their digestive systems.

Information courtesy of Alaska Dept. of Fish and Game.

Photo courtesy of Carey Carmichael Case of Wild Iris Photography

Staying safe while out on the water

The waters surrounding Mitkof Island provide ample opportunities for visitors to fish, spot wildlife and explore. Some basic safety precautions can make for a safer and more enjoyable experience on the waters of Frederick Sound, the Wrangell Narrows, the Stikine River, Petersburg Creek or wherever your adventures take you.

Petersburg Harbormaster Glorianne Wollen said having a float plan is her biggest piece of advice for those planning outings on the water. Let someone know where you are going, who you are with and when you plan to return.

In addition to that, monitoring the tides is also recommended. Many downtown retailers and banks have free tide books that can help visitors plan their water excursions and ensure they aren't left high and dry on a low tide.

Though it may be the most commonly cited advice, it's also the most likely to save your life: wear a life jacket! A life jacket or other personal flotation device not only adds a layer of insulation, but also allows you to save energy and use it for your rescue should you find yourself in the water.

Wearing base insulating, wicking layer (non-cotton) will help to keep you warm and dry.

A rain jacket is essential for most any excursion and will be especially appreciated to protect from spray or in case of getting caught in a downpour while on the water.

A quick check of the weather forecast is an easy way to ensure you're prepared for the day.

Finally, boaters should carry a VHF radio to signal the Coast Guard or nearby boaters in case of an emergency.

Be cautious when encountering bears

Mitkof Island is home mainly to black bears, though the larger and more aggressive brown bear has occasionally been spotted here. While bear encounters are often exaggerated, respect is warranted — though statistically, you're about 50 times more likely to be injured in a car on an Alaska highway than by a bear.

Never feed bears. It's illegal in Alaska, and it endangers both you and the animal.

If you see a cub, move away immediately — the mother is nearby, and placing yourself between a sow and her cubs is an open invitation to attack.

When camping, store and eat food well away from your sleeping area, and pack it separately from clothing to prevent scent transfer. On the trail, make noise — talk, sing, or attach bells to your pack. A surprised bear at close range may charge.

If you encounter a bear, do not run. Back away slowly without sudden movements. A startled bear may "whoosh" or "woof" as it flees — that's fine. If a bear holds its ground and begins woofing or popping its teeth, it may be preparing to charge: leave calmly.

For more information, contact the Petersburg Police Department, U.S. Forest Service, Visitor Information Center, or Alaska Department of Fish and Game.

Photo courtesy of Matthew Gerrits

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